John Viernes 10/6/2026

Modeling for the Future

Part 1: Future of Work Stress

My target role as a future Game Designer and/or Developer has changed little over the years, but has since had to make some compromises due to the rising powers of new-age technology and increasing demands. And now with the rise of AI, I fear it won't be long before my dream career starts being targeted. Creative Writing, I believe, will remain relatively unaffected, but Programming will be challenged, what with AI's new ability to whip up mountains of code on a whim. Not only that, but my own confidence in programming all by my lonesome is starting to see why it wasn't all its cracked up to be.

Looking five to ten years ahead, I no longer see the choice as simply "designer versus developer." Game design will likely become more connected to AI-assisted production, blending creative direction, systems thinking, prototyping, and tool supervision. MIT's *Work of the Future* report argues that technology often changes the tasks people do rather than instantly eliminating entire occupations. The larger question is how work is reorganized and who benefits (Autor, et al., 2020).

My own direction has become clearer. I originally weighed game development and game design, but design is more aligned with me. Programming often feels like learning a foreign language, and with limited time, I cannot make becoming a strong programmer the center of my plan. That does not mean I can ignore technical knowledge. A designer who understands what a game engine can do, how mechanics interact, and what is practical to build will communicate better with programmers and evaluate AI-generated prototypes more critically.

Some tasks are especially vulnerable to automation: boilerplate code, simple scripts, first-draft dialogue, concept variations, repetitive asset preparation, and routine quality checks. In Alharthi's (2025) study, which surveyed 42 game design professionals and interviewed nine, participants reported using generative AI for ideation (90.5%), asset creation (83.3%), and programming (73.8%). These numbers do not prove these tasks will disappear, especially given the study's small sample, but they show how AI is entering (or in my case, infiltrating) the pipeline. If employers can produce more drafts, assets, and code in just half the time or even less, entry-level work built mainly around repetitive tasks could become harder to secure. Still, output is not the same as a **good game.** It all relies on a HUMAN to decide whether a mechanic is fun, whether the story makes sense, whether difficulty feels fair, and whether generated content fits the game's tone and audience.

Lionbridge's discussion of automation in game audio offers a useful middle ground. Automation can reduce repetitive steps, connect workflows, and flag possible errors,

while human experts retain control over context-sensitive decisions and creative direction (Underwood, 2021). I expect that game designers of our time will have to work with AI rather than simply compete against it. Essential skills will include designing clear gameplay loops, planning levels, balancing mechanics, understanding player experience, writing useful design documents, playtesting, interpreting feedback, and explaining choices to artists and programmers. AI literacy will matter too: knowing how to prompt tools, check their output, spot generic or inaccurate results, and consider authorship and ethical use.

My current strategy is vulnerable in two ways. First, I have assumed creative writing will remain relatively untouched, but AI can already draft dialogue and story ideas. The more durable skill is not merely producing words. It is shaping a distinctive voice, maintaining narrative coherence, and deciding what a story should make players feel. Second, avoiding programming entirely would leave me less able to judge what is feasible or collaborate with technical teammates. The robust part of my strategy is choosing a role that fits my strengths and being willing to adapt. I do not need to out-code AI, but I do need enough technical fluency to direct it and assess its work.

Ultimately, I should measure progress by whether I can turn an idea into a coherent, playable experience and explain why its choices work, not by how much code I can write alone. My plan is to strengthen core design skills, build a portfolio of design documents and prototypes, learn enough engine basics to collaborate, and treat AI as an assistant, not an authority. The goal is not to produce the most material. It is to become the designer who knows what is worth making.

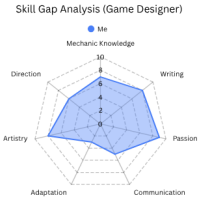
References

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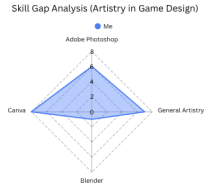
Alharthi, S. A. (2025). Generative AI in game design: Enhancing creativity or constraining innovation? *Journal of Intelligence, 13*(6), Article 60. https://doi.org/10.3390/jintelligence13060060

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Part 2: Revised Chart, Subcharts, and Plans (Steps 2 through 5 are here.)







Notable Information

Axis/Sub-Axis	What's Happening?	What to Improve
Communication	I am not much of a communicator, the only time's I ever were truly talkative were through games. All the groups I've been in were self-sufficient to a fault, not really needing my input, and I never had to address a problem that they or I had before.	I guess I ought to get out more, talk more with my group members, and even ask for help once in a while. It cant be as hard as talking to Mom or Dad, can it?
Blender	Just early September did I install Blender, all to learn how to model my own models. I barely even touched the thing.	I made a bunch of wierd things on Microsoft 3D Builder once, but this is a whole other ballpark. What better way to learn than to try it out.
Adobe Photoshop	It's been 2 ish years since I last saw my need in Adobe, I've since moved on to other kinds of software, like Canva, but now my career in Game Design tells me I am needed there more than ever.	I'll have to address any updates Adobe's apps may have had in the last 2 years, as well as warm myself back up to the old dog.

Skill Rating	
Level	**Description**
0-2	Total Newbie
3-5	Getting Somwhere
6-7	Amateur Hour
8-9	Knows His Way Around
10	Like The Back of His Hand

Planning for Later

	Competencies
Strongest	• Passion • Writing • Artistry
Weakest	• Mehcanic Knowledge • Communication • Direction • Adaptation

What to do Next:

- Communicate more with team mates, even abroad. Discord expertise can help.
- Mechanic Knowledge reffers not only to puzzles and stats, but also to Game Engine familiarity as well. I'm already beginning with Unity.
- Direction for my game is solid, but has much to be seen, I'll follow up on that soon.
- I'll have to prepare for anything down the development road that may lead to dead ends in the pipeline.